

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 2

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

002. Chapter 2 Verses 1-10

VERSE 2.1

सञ्जय उवाच ।
तं तथा कृपयाविष्टमश्रुपूर्णाकुलेक्षणम् ।
विषीदन्तमिदं वाक्यमुवाच मधुसूदनः ॥१॥

sañjaya uvācha

taṁ tathā kṛipayāviṣṭamaśhru pūrṇākulekṣhaṇam

viṣhīdantamidaṁ vākyaṁ uvācha madhusūdanaḥ

sañjayaḥ uvācha—Sanjay said; **taṁ**—to him (Arjun); **tathā**—thus; **kṛipayā**—with pity; **āviṣṭam**—filled; **aśhru pūrṇākulekṣhaṇam**—with eyes blurred with tears; **viṣhīdantam**—grief-stricken; **idaṁ vākyaṁ**—these words; **uvācha**—said; **madhusūdanaḥ**—Krishna

In this manner, when Arjuna was plunged in a state of despondency, with eyes blurred with tears, Lord Krishna addressed these words to him.

VERSE 2.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
कुतस्त्वा कश्मलमिदं विषमे समुपस्थितम् ।
अनार्यजुष्टमस्वर्ग्यमकीर्तिकरमर्जुन ॥२॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

kutastvā kaśhmalamidaṁ viṣhame samupasthitam

anārya-juṣṭamaswargyam akīrti-karam arjuna

Arjuna—O Arjuna!; **śhrī-bhagavān uvācha**—the Supreme Lord said; **kutaḥ**—wherefrom; **tvā**—to you; **kaśhmalam**—dejection; **idaṁ**—this; **viṣhame**—in this hour of peril; **samupasthitam**—taken hold; **anāryajuṣṭam**—unworthy; **aswargyam**—heaven-excluding; **akīrti-karam**—shameful

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Whence, in this critical situation, has this mental dejection takes hold of you, shameful and Heaven-excluding?

क्लैब्यं मा स्म गमः पार्थ नैतत्त्वय्युपपद्यते ।
क्षुद्रं हृदयदौर्बल्यं त्यक्त्वोत्तिष्ठ परन्तप ॥ ३ ॥

*klaibyaṁ mā sma gamaḥ pārtha naitat tvayyupapadyate
kṣhudraṁ hṛidaya-daurbalyaṁ tyaktvottiṣṭha parantapa*

klaibyam—impotence; **mā sma gamaḥ**—do not yield to; **pārtha**—O Arjuna!; **etat**—this; **tvayi**—to you; **na upapadyate**—is not fit; **kṣhudram**—mean; **hṛidaya-daurbalyaṁ**—weak-heartedness; **tyaktvā**—giving up; **uttiṣṭha**—arise; **param-tapa**—scorcher of enemies

O Arjuna! Do not yield to impotence. It does not befit you. Cast off this wretched weakness of heart. Arise, O scorcher of enemies!

अर्जुन उवाच ।
कथं भीष्ममहं सङ्ख्ये द्रोणं च मधुसूदन ।
इषुभिः प्रतियोत्स्यामि पूजार्हावरिसूदन ॥ ४ ॥

*arjuna uvācha
kathaṁ bhīṣhmam ahaṁ sankhye droṇaṁ cha madhusūdana
iṣhubhiḥ pratiyotsyāmi pūjārḥāvari-sūdana*

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **katham**—how; **bhīṣhmam**—Bheeshma; **aham**—I; **sankhye**—in battle; **droṇam**—Dronacharya; **cha**—and; **madhu-sūdana**—Shree Krishn, slayer of the Madhu demon; **iṣhubhiḥ**—with arrows; **pratiyotsyāmi**—shall I shoot; **pūjā-arḥau**—worthy of worship; **ari-sūdana**—destroyer of enemies

Arjuna Said: O Krishna! Bhishma and Drona are my teachers fit to be worshipped. How can I attack them with arrows in the battle?

गुरुनहत्वा हि महानुभावान्
श्रेयो भोक्तुं भैक्ष्यमपीह लोके ।
हत्वार्थकामांस्तु गुरुनिहैव
भुञ्जीय भोगान् रुधिरप्रदिग्धान् ॥५॥

*gurūnahatvā hi mahānubhāvān
śhreyo bhoktum bhaikṣhyamapīha loke
hatvārtha-kāmānstu gurūnihaiva
bhuñjīya bhogān rudhira-pradigdhān*

gurūn—teachers; **ahatvā**—not killing; **hi**—certainly; **mahā-anubhāvān**—noble elders; **śhreyaḥ**—better; **bhoktum**—to enjoy life; **bhaikṣhyam**—by begging; **api**—even; **iha loke**—in this world; **hatvā**—killing; **artha**—gain; **kāmān**—desiring; **tu**—but; **gurūn**—noble elders; **iha**—in this world; **eva**—certainly; **bhuñjīya**—enjoy; **bhogān**—pleasures; **rudhira**—blood; **pradigdhān**—tainted with

It would be better, indeed, to live on alms in this world rather than to slay these high-souled teachers. But if I kill them, even here I shall enjoy wealth and desires stained with their blood.

न चैतद्विद्मः कतरन्नो गरीयो
यद्वा जयेम यदि वा नो जयेयुः ।
यानेव हत्वा न जिजीविषाम
स्तेऽवस्थिताः प्रमुखे धार्तराष्ट्राः ॥ ६ ॥

*na chaitadvidmaḥ kataranno garīyo
yadvā jayema yadi vā no jayeyuḥ
yāneva hatvā na jijīviṣhāmas
te 'vasthitāḥ pramukhe dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ*

na—not; cha—and; etat—this; vidmaḥ—we know; katarat—which; naḥ—for us; garīyaḥ—is preferable; yat vā—whether; jayema—we may conquer; yadi—if; vā—or; naḥ—us; jayeyuḥ—they may conquer; yān—whom; eva—certainly; hatvā—after killing; na—not; jijīviṣhāmaḥ—we desire to live; te—they; avasthitāḥ—are standing; pramukhe—before us; dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ—the sons of Dhritarashtra

We do not know which would be the better for us: that we should conquer them or they should conquer us. Arrayed against us stand the very sons of Dhritarāshtra, after slaying whom we should not wish to live.

कार्पण्यदोषोपहतस्वभावः
पृच्छामि त्वां धर्मसम्मूढचेताः ।
यच्छ्रेयः स्यान्निश्चितं ब्रूहि तन्मे
शिष्यस्तेऽहं शाधि मां त्वां प्रपन्नम् ॥ ७ ॥

*kārpanya-doṣhopahata-svabhāvaḥ
prichchhāmi tvāṁ dharma-sammūḍha-chetāḥ
yach-chhreyaḥ syānniśchitaṁ brūhi tanme
śhiṣhyaste 'haṁ śhādhi māṁ tvāṁ prapannam*

kārpanya-doṣha—the flaw of cowardice; **upahata**—besieged; **sva-bhāvaḥ**—nature; **prichchhāmi**—I am asking; **tvām**—to you; **dharma**—duty; **sammūḍha**—confused; **chetāḥ**—in heart; **yat**—what; **śhreyaḥ**—best; **syāt**—may be; **niśchitam**—decisively; **brūhi**—tell; **tat**—that; **me**—to me; **śhiṣhyaḥ**—disciple; **te**—your; **aham**—I; **śhādhi**—please instruct; **mām**—me; **tvām**—unto you; **prapannam**—surrendered

(O Krishna!) My mind is distracted by the taint of pity and I am ignorant of what my duty is, and so, I ask you to teach me what is good for me. I am your disciple. I take refuge in you.

न हि प्रपश्यामि ममापनुद्याद्
यच्छोकमुच्छोषणमिन्द्रियाणाम् ।
अवाप्य भूमावसपत्नमृद्धं
राज्यं सुराणामपि चाधिपत्यम् ॥८॥

*na hi prapaśhyāmi mamāpanudyād
yach-chhokam uchchhoṣhaṇam-indriyāṇām
avāpya bhūmāv-asapatnamṛiddham
rājyaṁ surāṇāmapi chādhipatyam*

na—not; hi—certainly; prapaśhyāmi—I see; mama—my; apanudyāt—drive away; yat—which; śhokam—anguish; uchchhoṣhaṇam—is drying up; indriyāṇām—of the senses; avāpya—after achieving; bhūmau—on the earth; asapatnam—unrivalled; ṛiddham—prosperous; rājyam—kingdom; surāṇām—like the celestial gods; api—even; cha—also; ādhipatyam—sovereignty

I can find no means to drive away this grief which is drying up my senses. I will not be able to dispel it even if I win a prosperous, unrivaled kingdom on earth with sovereignty like the demigods in heaven.

सञ्जय उवाच ।
एवमुक्त्वा हृषीकेशं गुडाकेशः परन्तप ।
न योत्स्य इति गोविन्दमुक्त्वा तूष्णीं बभूव ह ॥९॥

*sañjaya uvācha
evam-uktvā hrīṣhīkeśhaṁ guḍākeśhaḥ parantapa
na yotsya iti govindam uktvā tūṣhṇīm babhūva ha*

sañjayaḥ uvācha—Sanjaya said; evam—thus; uktvā—having spoken; hrīṣhīkeśhaṁ—to Shree Krishna, the master of the mind and senses; guḍākeśhaḥ—Arjun, the conquerer of sleep; parantapaḥ—Arjun, the chastiser of the enemies; na yotsye—I shall not fight; iti—thus; govindam—Krishna, the giver of pleasure to the senses; uktvā—having addressed; tūṣhṇīm—silent; babhūva—became ha

Sanjaya Said: Having spoke thus, Arjuna, the destroyer of foes, finally said to Lord Krishna, “I will not fight” and became silent.

तमुवाच हृषीकेशः प्रहसन्निव भारत ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये विषीदन्तमिदं वचः ॥ १० ॥

*tam-uvācha hrīṣhīkeśhaḥ prahasanniva bhārata
senayorubhayor-madhye viśhīdantam-idam vachaḥ*

tam—to him; **uvācha**—said; **hrīṣhīkeśhaḥ**—Shree Krishna, the master of mind and senses; **prahasan**—smilingly; **iva**—as if; **bhārata**—Dhritarashtra, descendant of Bharat; **senayoh**—of the armies; **ubhayoh**—of both; **madhye**—in the midst of; **viśhīdantam**—to the grief-stricken; **idam**—this; **vachaḥ**—words

O king Dhritarashtra! Seeing Arjuna lamenting in the middle of two armies, Lord Krishna, as if laughing loud, spoke these words.

003. Chapter 2 Verses 11-12

VERSE 2.11

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
अशोच्यानन्वशोचस्त्वं प्रज्ञावादांश्च भाषसे ।
गतासूनगतासूंश्च नानुशोचन्ति पण्डिताः ॥ 11 ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha
aśhochyān-anvaśhochas-tvaṁ prajñā-vādānś cha bhāṣhase
gatāsūn-agatāsūnś-cha nānuśhochanti paṇḍitāḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Lord said; **aśhochyān**—not worthy of grief; **anvaśhochāḥ**—are mourning; **tvam**—you; **prajñā-vādān**—words of wisdom; **cha**—and; **bhāṣhase**—speaking; **gata āsūn**—the dead; **agata asūn**—the living; **cha**—and; **na**—never; **anuśhochanti**—lament; **paṇḍitāḥ**—the wise

The Lord said: O Arjuna! You grieve for those for whom there need be no sorrow, yet you speak words of wisdom. The wise do not grieve for the dead or living.

VERSE 2.12

न त्वेवाहं जातु नासं न त्वं नेमे जनाधिपा ।
न चैव न भविष्यामः सर्वे वयमतः परम् ॥ 12 ॥

na tvevāhaṁ jātu nāsaṁ na tvam neme janādhipāḥ
na chaiva na bhaviṣhyāmaḥ sarve vayamataḥ param

na—never; **tu**—however; **eva**—certainly; **aham**—I; **jātu**—at any time; **na**—nor; **āsam**—exist; **na**—nor; **tvam**—you; **na**—nor; **ime**—these; **jana-adhipāḥ**—kings; **na**—never; **cha**—also; **eva**—indeed; **na bhaviṣhyāmaḥ**—shall not exist; **sarve vayam**—all of us; **ataḥ**—from now; **param**—after

Never was there a time when I did not exist, nor you, nor these kings of men. Never will there be a time hereafter when any of us shall cease to be.

004. Chapter 2 Verses 13-15

VERSE 2.13

देहिनोऽस्मिन्यथा देहे कौमारं यौवनं जरा ।
तथा देहान्तरप्राप्तिर्धीरस्तत्र न मुह्यति ॥ 13 ॥

*dehino 'smin yathā dehe kaumāraṁ yauvanam jarā
tathā dehāntara-prāptir dhīras tatra na muhyati*

dehinaḥ—of the embodied; **asmin**—in this; **yathā**—as; **dehe**—in the body; **kaumāram**—childhood; **yauvanam**—youth; **jarā**—old age; **tathā**—similarly; **deha-antara**—another body; **prāptiḥ**—achieves; **dhīraḥ**—the wise; **tatra**—thereupon; **na muhyati**—are not deluded

Just as the man in this body passes through the various stages of boyhood, youth, and old age, like so, he passes into another body after death. The wise know it and are not deluded.

VERSE 2.14

मात्रास्पर्शास्तु कौन्तेय शीतोष्णसुखदुःखदाः ।
आगमापायिनोऽनित्यास्तांस्तितिक्षस्व भारत ॥ 14 ॥

*mātrā-sparśhās tu kaunteya śhītoṣṇa-sukha-duḥkha-dāḥ
āgamāpāyino 'nityās tans-titikṣhasva bhārata*

mātrā-sparśhāḥ—contact of the senses with the sense objects; **tu**—indeed; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **śhīta**—winter; **uṣhṇa**—summer; **sukha**—happiness; **duḥkha**—distress; **dāḥ**—give; **āgama**—come; **apāyinaḥ**—go; **anityāḥ**—non-permanent; **tān**—them; **titikṣhasva**—tolerate; **bhārata**—descendant of the Bharat

Contact of the senses with the objects produces heat and cold, pain and pleasure. These experiences come and go, and are impermanent. Endure them, O Arjuna!

यं हि न व्यथयन्त्येते पुरुषं पुरुषर्षभ ।
समदुःखसुखं धीरं सोऽमृतत्वाय कल्पते ॥ 15 ॥

*yam hi na vyathayantyete puruṣhaṁ puruṣharṣhabha
sama-duḥkha-sukhaṁ dhīraṁ so 'mṛitatvāya kalpate*

yam—whom; **hi**—verily; **na**—not; **vyathayanti**—distressed; **ete**—these; **puruṣham**—person; **puruṣha-ṛiṣhabha**—the noblest amongst men, Arjun; **sama**—equipoised; **duḥkha**—distress; **sukham**—happiness; **dhīram**—steady; **sah**—that person; **amṛitatvāya**—for liberation; **kalpate**—becomes eligible

The firm man who is not affected by pain and pleasure, who remains equal-minded, surely is fit for immortality, O Arjuna, Chief of mortals!

005. Chapter 2 Verse 16

VERSE 2.16

नासतो विद्यते भावो नाभावो विद्यते सतः ।
उभयोरपि दृष्टो ऽन्तस्त्वनयोस्तत्त्वदर्शिभिः ॥ 16 ॥

*nāsato vidyate bhāvo nābhāvo vidyate sataḥ
ubhayorapi dṛiṣṭo 'nta stvanayos tattva-darśhibhiḥ*

na—no; **asataḥ**—of the temporary; **vidyate**—there is; **bhāvaḥ**—is; **na**—no; **abhāvaḥ**—cessation; **vidyate**—is; **sataḥ**—of the eternal; **ubhayoḥ**—of the two; **api**—also; **dṛiṣṭaḥ**—observed; **antaḥ**—conclusion; **tu**—verily; **anayoḥ**—of these; **tattva**—of the truth; **darśhibhiḥ**—by the seers

The unreal has no being, the real has no non-being. The final truth of these two has been seen indeed by those who have experienced the essence of things.

006. Chapter 2 Verses 17-18

VERSE 2.17

अविनाशि तु तद्विद्धि येन सर्वमिदं ततम् ।
विनाशमव्ययस्यास्य न कश्चित्कर्तुमर्हति ॥ 17 ॥

*avināśhi tu tadviddhi yena sarvam idam tatam
vināśham avyayasyāsyā na kaśhchit kartum arhati*

avināśhi—indestructible; tu—indeed; tat—that; viddhi—know; yena—by whom; sarvam—entire; idam—this; tatam—pervaded; vināśham—destruction; avyayasya—of the imperishable; asya—of it; na kaśhchit—no one; kartum—to cause; arhati—is able

**(O Arjuna!) Know that Atma by which the whole universe is pervaded is indestructible.
No one can cause the destruction of the imperishable.**

VERSE 2.18

अन्तवन्त इमे देहा नित्यस्योक्ताः शरीरिणः ।
अनाशिनोऽप्रमेयस्य तस्माद्युध्यस्व भारत ॥ 18 ॥

*antavanta ime dehā nityasyuktāḥ śharīriṇaḥ
anāśhino 'prameyasya tasmād yudhyasva bhārata*

anta-vantaḥ—having an end; ime—these; dehāḥ—material bodies; nityasya—eternally; uktāḥ—are said; śharīriṇaḥ—of the embodied soul; anāśhinaḥ—indestructible; aprameyasya—immeasurable; tasmāt—therefore; yudhyasva—fight; bhārata—descendant of Bharat, Arjun

**These bodies which belong to the real imperishable, unknowable Atma are said to be
subject to an end; therefore fight, O Arjuna!**

007. Chapter 2 Verse 19

VERSE 2.19

य एनं वेत्ति हन्तारं यश्चैनं मन्यते हतम् ।
उभौ तौ न विजानीतो नायं हन्ति न हन्यते ॥ 19 ॥

*ya enam vetti hantāram yaśh chainam manyate hatam
ubhau tau na vijānīto nāyam hanti na hanyate*

yaḥ—one who; **enam**—this; **vetti**—knows; **hantāram**—the slayer; **yaḥ**—one who; **cha**—and; **enam**—this; **manyate**—thinks; **hatam**—slain; **ubhau**—both; **tau**—they; **na**—not; **vijānītaḥ**—in knowledge; **na**—neither; **ayam**—this; **hanti**—slays; **na**—nor; **hanyate**—is killed

He who thinks that Atma slays, or he who thinks that Atma is Slain, both these do not know the Truth. Atma does not slay, nor is slain.

008. Chapter 2 Verse 20-22

VERSE 2.20

न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचि
नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः ।
अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो
न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ 20 ॥

*na jāyate mriyate vā kadāchin
nāyaṁ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ
ajo nityaḥ śhāśhvato 'yaṁ purāṇo
na hanyate hanyamāne śharīre*

na jāyate—is not born; **mriyate**—dies; **vā**—or; **kadāchit**—at any time; **na**—not; **ayam**—this; **bhūtvā**—having once existed; **bhavitā**—will be; **vā**—or; **na**—not; **bhūyaḥ**—further; **ajaḥ**—unborn; **nityaḥ**—eternal; **śhāśhvataḥ**—immortal; **ayam**—this; **purāṇaḥ**—the ancient; **na hanyate**—is not destroyed; **hanyamāne**—is destroyed; **śharīre**—when the body

Atma is not born, nor does it ever die; after having been it does not cease to be, unborn, eternal, changeless and ancient, it is not killed when the body is destroyed.

VERSE 2.21

DEVAGIAवेदाविनाशिनं नित्यं य एनमजमव्ययम् ।
कथं स पुरुषः पार्थ कं घातयति हन्ति कम् ॥ 21 ॥

*vedāvināśhinam nityam ya enam ajam avyayam
katham sa puruṣaḥ pārtha kaṁ ghātayati hanti kam*

veda—knows; **avināśhinam**—imperishable; **nityam**—eternal; **yaḥ**—who; **enam**—this; **ajam**—unborn; **avyayam**—immutable; **katham**—how; **saḥ**—that; **puruṣaḥ**—person; **pārtha**—Parth; **kam**—whom; **ghātayati**—causes to be killed; **hanti**—kills; **kam**—whom

O Arjuna! He who knows that Atma is birthless, deathless, real, and imperishable, whom can he slay or cause to be slain?

वासांसि जीर्णानि यथा विहाय
नवानि गृह्णाति नरोऽपराणि ।
तथा शरीराणि विहाय जीर्णा
न्यन्यानि संयाति नवानि देही ॥ 22 ॥

*vāsānsi jīrṇāni yathā vihāya
navāni gṛhṇāti naro 'parāṇi
tathā śharīrāṇi vihāya jīrṇānya
nyāni sanyāti navāni dehī*

vāsānsi—garments; **jīrṇāni**—worn-out; **yathā**—as; **vihāya**—sheds; **navāni**—new; **gṛhṇāti**—accepts; **naraḥ**—a person; **aparāṇi**—others; **tathā**—likewise; **śharīrāṇi**—bodies; **vihāya**—casting off; **jīrṇāni**—worn-out; **anyāni**—other; **sanyāti**—enters; **navāni**—new; **dehī**—the embodied soul

Just as a man casts off his worn-out clothes and puts on new ones so also the Self throws away its worn-out bodies and takes other fresh bodies.

009. Chapter 2 Verse 23-25

VERSE 2.23

नैनं छिन्दन्ति शस्त्राणि नैनं दहति पावकः ।
न चैनं क्लेदयन्त्यापो न शोषयति मारुतः ॥ 23 ॥

*nainam chhindanti śhastrāṇi nainam dahati pāvakaḥ
na chainam kledayantyāpo na śhoṣhayati mārutaḥ*

na—not; enam—this soul; chhindanti—shred; śhastrāṇi—weapons; na—not; enam—this soul; dahati—burns; pāvakaḥ—fire; na—not; cha—and; enam—this soul; kledayanti—moisten; āpaḥ—water; na—not; śhoṣhayati—dry; mārutaḥ—wind

Weapons cannot cut, fire cannot burn, water cannot wet, wind cannot dry up this Atma.

VERSE 2.24

अच्छेद्योऽयमदाह्योऽयमक्लेद्योऽशोष्य एव च ।
नित्यः सर्वगतः स्थाणुरचलोऽयं सनातनः ॥ 24 ॥

*achchhedyo 'yam adāhyo 'yam akledyo 'śhoṣhya eva cha
nityaḥ sarva-gataḥ sthāṇur achalo 'yam sanātanaḥ*

achchhedyaḥ—unbreakable; ayam—this soul; adāhyaḥ—incombustible; ayam—this soul; akledyaḥ—cannot be dampened; aśhoṣhyaḥ—cannot be dried; eva—indeed; cha—and; nityaḥ—everlasting; sarva-gataḥ—all-pervading; sthāṇuḥ—unalterable; achalaḥ—immutable; ayam—this soul; sanātanaḥ—primordial

The Atma cannot be cut, cannot be burnt, cannot be wetted, and also cannot be dried up. It is eternal, all-pervading, firm, immovable, and ancient.

अव्यक्तोऽयमचिन्त्योऽयमविकार्योऽयमुच्यते ।
तस्मादेवं विदित्वैनं नानुशोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 25 ॥

avyakto 'yam achintyo 'yam avikāryo 'yam uchyate
tasmādevaṁ viditvainaṁ nānuśhochitum arhasi

avyaktaḥ—unmanifested; **ayam**—this soul; **achintyaḥ**—inconceivable; **ayam**—this soul; **avikāryaḥ**—unchangeable; **ayam**—this soul; **uchyate**—is said; **tasmāt**—therefore; **evam**—thus; **viditvā**—having known; **enam**—this soul; **na**—not; **anuśhochitum**—to grieve; **arhasi**—befitting

This self is unknowable by the senses, unthinkable by the mind, and is not subject to any kind of change. Knowing this, you should not grieve.

010. Chapter 2 Verse 26-27

VERSE 2.26

अथ चैनं नित्यजातं नित्यं वा मन्यसे मृतम् ।
तथापि त्वं महाबाहो नैवं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 26 ॥

atha chainam nitya-jātam nityam vā manyase mṛitam
tathāpi tvam mahā-bāho naivam śhochitum arhasi

atha—if, however; **cha**—and; **enam**—this soul; **nitya-jātam**—taking constant birth; **nityam**—always; **vā**—or; **manyase**—you think; **mṛitam**—dead; **tathā api**—even then; **tvam**—you; **mahā-bāho**—mighty-armed one, Arjun; **na**—not; **evam**—like this; **śhochitum**—grieve; **arhasi**—befitting

O mighty-armed Arjuna! Even if you think that Self is constantly born and dies, you should not grieve in this way.

VERSE 2.27

जातस्य हि ध्रुवो मृत्युर्ध्रुवं जन्म मृतस्य च ।
तस्मादपरिहार्येऽर्थे न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 27 ॥

jātasya hi dhruvo mṛityur dhruvam janma mṛitasya cha
tasmād aparihārye 'rthe na tvam śhochitum arhasi

jātasya—for one who has been born; **hi**—for; **dhruvaḥ**—certain; **mṛityuḥ**—death; **dhruvam**—certain; **janma**—birth; **mṛitasya**—for the dead; **cha**—and; **tasmāt**—therefore; **aparihārye arthe**—in this inevitable situation; **na**—not; **tvam**—you; **śhochitum**—lament; **arhasi**—befitting

For to that which is born, death is certain, and to that which is dead, birth is certain. Therefore you should not grieve over the unavoidable.

011. Chapter 2 Verses 28-29

VERSE 2.28

अव्यक्तादीनि भूतानि व्यक्तमध्यानि भारत ।
अव्यक्तनिधनान्येव तत्र का परिदेवना ॥ 28 ॥

*avyaktādīni bhūtāni vyakta-madhyāni bhārata
avyakta-nidhanānyeva tatra kā paridevanā*

avyakta-ādīni—unmanifest before birth; **bhūtāni**—created beings; **vyakta**—manifest; **madhyāni**—in the middle; **bhārata**—Arjun, scion of Bharat; **avyakta**—unmanifest; **nidhanāni**—on death; **eva**—indeed; **tatra**—therefore; **kā**—why; **paridevanā**—grieve

All beings are unmanifest in their beginning, O Bhārata, manifest in their middle state, and unmanifest again in their end. Why, then, lament for them?

VERSE 2.29

आश्चर्यवत्पश्यति कश्चिदेन
माश्चर्यवद्वदति तथैव चान्यः ।
आश्चर्यवच्चैनमन्यः शृणोति
श्रुत्वाप्येनं वेद न चैव कश्चित् ॥ 29 ॥

*āśhcharya-vat paśhyati kaśhchid enan
āśhcharya-vad vadati tathaiva chānyaḥ
āśhcharya-vach chainam anyaḥ śhṛiṇoti
śhurutvāpyenam veda na chaiva kaśhchit*

āśhcharya-vat—as amazing; **paśhyati**—see; **kaśhchit**—someone; **enam**—this soul; **āśhcharya-vat**—as amazing; **vadati**—speak of; **tathā**—thus; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and; **anyaḥ**—other; **āśhcharya-vat**—similarly amazing; **cha**—also; **enam**—this soul; **anyaḥ**—others; **śhṛiṇoti**—hear; **śhurutvā**—having heard; **api**—even; **enam**—this soul; **veda**—understand; **na**—not; **cha**—and; **eva**—even; **kaśhchit**—some

Some look on the Self as a wonder; some speak of It as a wonder; some hear of It as a wonder; still others, though hearing, do not understand It at all.

012. Chapter 2 Verses 30-31

VERSE 2.30

देही नित्यमवध्योऽयं देहे सर्वस्य भारत ।
तस्मात्सर्वाणि भूतानि न त्वं शोचितुमर्हसि ॥ 30 ॥

*dehī nityam avadhyo 'yam dehe sarvasya bhārata
tasmāt sarvāṇi bhūtāni na tvam śhochitum arhasi*

dehī—the soul that dwells within the body; **nityam**—always; **avadhyaḥ**—immortal; **ayam**—this soul; **dehe**—in the body; **sarvasya**—of everyone; **bhārata**—descendant of Bharat, Arjun; **tasmāt**—therefore; **sarvāṇi**—for all; **bhūtāni**—living entities; **na**—not; **tvam**—you; **śhochitum**—mourn; **arhasi**—should

O Arjuna! The Self existing in the body of all beings is never slain. So it is not right for you to grieve for any creature.

VERSE 2.31

स्वधर्ममपि चावेक्ष्य न विकम्पितुमर्हसि ।
धर्म्याद्धि युद्धाच्छ्रेयोऽन्यत्क्षत्रियस्य न विद्यते ॥ 31 ॥

*swa-dharmam api chāvekṣhya na vikampitum arhasi
dharmyāddhi yuddhāch chhreyo 'nyat kṣhatriyasya na vidyate*

swa-dharmam—one's duty in accordance with the Vedas; **api**—also; **cha**—and; **avekṣhya**—considering; **na**—not; **vikampitum**—to waver; **arhasi**—should; **dharmyāt**—for righteousness; **hi**—indeed; **yuddhāt**—than fighting; **śhreyah**—better; **anyat**—another; **kṣhatriyasya**—of a warrior; **na**—not; **vidyate**—exists

And moreover, considering your own duty, you should not waver, for, there is nothing higher for a Kshatriya than a righteous war.

013. Chapter 2 Verses 32-38

VERSE 2.32

यदृच्छया चोपपन्नं स्वर्गद्वारमपावृतम् ।
सुखिनः क्षत्रियाः पार्थ लभन्ते युद्धमीदृशम् ॥ 32 ॥

*yadṛichchhayā chopapannam swarga-dvāram apāvṛitam
sukhinaḥ kṣatriyāḥ pārtha labhante yuddham īdṛiṣham*

yadṛichchhayā—unsought; cha—and; upapannam—come; swarga—celestial abodes; dvāram—door; apāvṛitam—wide open; sukhinaḥ—happy; kṣatriyāḥ—warriors; pārtha—Arjun, the son of Pritha; labhante—obtain; yuddham—war; īdṛiṣham—such

Happy indeed are the kshatriyas, O Pārtha, to whom comes such a war, offering itself unsought, opening the gate to heaven.

VERSE 2.33

अथ चेतत्त्वमिमं धर्म्यं संग्रामं न करिष्यसि ।
ततः स्वधर्मं कीर्तिं च हित्वा पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ 33 ॥

*atha chet tvam imam dharmyam saṅgrāmam na kariṣhyasi
tataḥ sva-dharmam kīrtim cha hitvā pāpam avāpsyasi*

atha chet—if, however; tvam—you; imam—this; dharmyam saṅgrāmam—righteous war; na—not; kariṣhyasi—act; tataḥ—then; sva-dharmam—one’s duty in accordance with the Vedas; kīrtim—reputation; cha—and; hitvā—abandoning; pāpam—sin; avāpsyasi—will incur

But if you do not fight this righteous war you would incur sin by abandoning your own duty, name, and fame.

अकीर्तिं चापि भूतानि
कथयिष्यन्ति तेऽव्ययाम् ।
सम्भावितस्य चाकीर्तिं
मरणादतिरिच्यते ॥ 34 ॥

*akīrtiṁ chāpi bhūtāni
kathayiṣhyanti te 'vyayām
sambhāvitasya chākīrtir
maraṇād atirichyate*

akīrtim—infamy; **cha**—and; **api**—also; **bhūtāni**—people; **kathayiṣhyanti**—will speak; **te**—of your; **avyayām**—everlasting; **sambhāvitasya**—of a respectable person; **cha**—and; **akīrtiḥ**—infamy; **marañāt**—than death; **atirichyate**—is greater

And also, these people will speak of your everlasting dishonor, and to one who is honored, dishonor is worse than death.

भयाद्राणादुपरतं मंस्यन्ते त्वां महारथाः ।
येषां च त्वं बहुमतो भूत्वा यास्यसि लाघवम् ॥ 35 ॥

*bhayād raṇād uparataṁ mansyante tvāṁ mahā-rathāḥ
yeṣhām cha tvam bahu-mato bhūtvā yāsyasi lāghavam*

bhayāt—out of fear; **raṇāt**—from the battlefield; **uparatam**—have fled; **manṣyante**—will think; **tvām**—you; **mahā-rathāḥ**—warriors who could single handedly match the strength of ten thousand ordinary warriors; **yeṣhām**—for whom; **cha**—and; **tvam**—you; **bahu-mataḥ**—high esteemed; **bhūtvā**—having been; **yāsyasi**—you will loose; **lāghavam**—decreased in value

Moreover, those great warriors from whom you received honor formerly would think that you turned away from battle out of fear, and regard you with little respect hereafter.

अवाच्यवादांश्च बहून्वदिष्यन्ति तवाहिताः ।
निन्दन्तस्तव सामर्थ्यं ततो दुःखतरं नु किम् ॥ 36 ॥

*avāchya-vādānś cha bahūn vadiṣhyanti tavāhitāḥ
nindantastava sāmārthyam tato duḥkhataram nu kim*

avāchya-vādān—using harsh words; cha—and; bahūn—many; vadiṣhyanti—will say; tava—your; ahitāḥ—enemies; nindantaḥ—defame; tava—your; sāmārthyam—might; tataḥ—than that; duḥkha-taram—more painful; nu—indeed; kim—what

Your enemies belittle your ability, and in various ways speak words of ill-fame and shame about you. What is there more painful than this?

हतो वा प्राप्स्यसि स्वर्गं जित्वा वा भोक्ष्यसे महीम् ।
तस्मादुत्तिष्ठ कौन्तेय युद्धाय कृतनिश्चयः ॥ 37 ॥

*hato vā prāpsyasi swargam jitvā vā bhokṣhyase mahīm
tasmād uttiṣṭha kaunteya yuddhāya kṛita-niśchayaḥ*

hataḥ—slain; vā—or; prāpsyasi—you will attain; swargam—celestial abodes; jitvā—by achieving victory; vā—or; bhokṣhyase—you shall enjoy; mahīm—the kingdom on earth; tasmāt—therefore; uttiṣṭha—arise; kaunteya—Arjun, the son of Kunti; yuddhāya—for fight; kṛita-niśchayaḥ—with determination

If you are killed in the battle, you will go to heaven; if you win, you will enjoy the earth. Therefore arise, O son of Kunti, resolved to fight.

सुखदुःखे समे कृत्वा लाभालाभौ जयाजयौ ।
ततो युद्धाय युज्यस्व नैवं पापमवाप्स्यसि ॥ ३८ ॥

*sukha-duḥkhe same kṛtvā lābhālābhau jayājayau
tato yuddhāya yujyasva naivaṁ pāpam avāpsyasi*

sukha—happiness; **duḥkhe**—in distress; **same kṛtvā**—treating alike; **lābha-alābhau**—gain and loss; **jaya-ajayau**—victory and defeat; **tataḥ**—thereafter; **yuddhāya**—for fighting; **yujyasva**—engage; **na**—never; **evam**—thus; **pāpam**—sin; **avāpsyasi**—shall incur

Having an equal mind in pain and pleasure, gain and loss, victory and defeat, engage in battle and thereby you will not incur sin.

014. Chapter 2 Verses 39-40

VERSE 2.39

एषा तेऽभिहिता साङ्ख्ये
बुद्धिर्योगे त्विमां शृणु ।
बुद्ध्या युक्तो यया पार्थ
कर्मबन्धं प्रहास्यसि ॥ 39 ॥

*eṣhā te 'bhihitā sāṅkhye
buddhir yoge tvimāṁ śṛiṇu
buddhyā yukto yayā pārtha
karma-bandhaṁ prahāsyasi*

eṣhā—hitherto; **te**—to you; **abhihitā**—explained; **sāṅkhye**—by analytical knowledge; **buddhiḥ yoge**—by the yog of intellect; **tu**—indeed; **imāṁ**—this; **śṛiṇu**—listen; **buddhyā**—by understanding; **yuktaḥ**—united; **yayā**—by which; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **karma-bandham**—bondage of karma; **prahāsyasi**—you shall be released from

O Arjuna! So far the knowledge of Sankhya Yoga about Atma is declared. Now hear the knowledge of Karma Yoga, knowing which you shall cast off the bondage of work.

VERSE 2.40

नेहाभिक्रमनाशोऽस्ति प्रत्यवायो न विद्यते ।
स्वल्पमप्यस्य धर्मस्य त्रायते महतो भयात् ॥ 40 ॥

*nehābhikrama-nāśho 'sti pratyavāyo na vidyate
svalpam apyasya dharmasya trāyate mahato bhayāt*

na—not; **iha**—in this; **abhikrama**—efforts; **nāśhaḥ**—loss; **asti**—there is; **pratyavāyaḥ**—adverse result; **na**—not; **vidyate**—is; **su-alpam**—a little; **api**—even; **asya**—of this; **dharmasya**—occupation; **trāyate**—saves; **mahataḥ**—from great; **bhayāt**—danger

In this, no effort is ever lost and no harm is ever done. Even very little of this dharma saves a man from the Great Fear.

015. Chapter 2 Verses 41-44

VERSE 2.41

व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिरेकेह कुरुनन्दन ।
बहुशाखा ह्यनन्ताश्च बुद्धयोऽव्यवसायिनाम् ॥ 41 ॥

vyavasāyātmikā buddhir ekeha kuru-nandana
bahu-śhākhā hyanantāśh cha buddhayo 'vyavasāyinām

vyavasāya-ātmikā—resolute; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **ekā**—single; **iha**—on this path; **kuru-nandana**—descendent of the Kurus; **bahu-śhākhāḥ**—many-branched; **hi**—indeed; **anantāḥ**—endless; **cha**—also; **buddhayaḥ**—intellect; **avyavasāyinām**—of the irresolute

O Arjuna! There is only one faith and thought for those who practice this Karma Yoga. The minds of others are divided into various branches, and their thoughts and speculations are endless.

यामिमां पुष्पितां वाचं प्रवदन्त्यविपश्चितः ।
 वेदवादरताः पार्थ नान्यदस्तीति वादिनः ॥ 42 ॥
 कामात्मानः स्वर्गपरा जन्मकर्मफलप्रदाम् ।
 क्रियाविशेषबहुलां भोगैश्वर्यगतिं प्रति ॥ 43 ॥
 भोगैश्वर्यप्रसक्तानां तयापहृतचेतसाम् ।
 व्यवसायात्मिका बुद्धिः समाधौ न विधीयते ॥ 44 ॥

*yāmimāṁ puṣhpitāṁ vāchaṁ pravadanty-avipaśhchitaḥ
 veda-vāda-ratāḥ pārtha nānyad astīti vādinaḥ
 kāmātmānaḥ swarga-parā janma-karma-phala-pradām
 kriyā-viśheṣha-bahulāṁ bhogaiśhwarya-gatiṁ prati
 bhogaiśwarya-prasaktānāṁ tayāpahṛita-chetasām
 vyavasāyātmikā buddhiḥ samādhau na vidhīyate*

yām imām—all these; **puṣhpitām**—flowery; **vācham**—words; **pravadanti**—speak; **avipaśhchitaḥ**—those with limited understanding; **veda-vāda-ratāḥ**—attached to the flowery words of the Vedas; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **na anyat**—no other; **asti**—is; **iti**—thus; **vādinaḥ**—advocate; **kāma-ātmānaḥ**—desirous of sensual pleasure; **swarga-parāḥ**—aiming to achieve the heavenly planets; **janma-karma-phala**—high birth and fruitive results; **pradām**—awarding; **kriyā-viśheṣha**—pompous ritualistic ceremonies; **bahulām**—various; **bhoga**—gratification; **aiśhwarya**—luxury; **gatiṁ**—progress; **prati**—toward bhoga—gratification; **aiśhwarya**—luxury; **prasaktānām**—whose minds are deeply attached; **tayā**—by that; **apahṛita-chetasām**—bewildered in intellect; **vyavasāya-ātmikā**—resolute; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **samādhau**—fulfilment; **na**—never; **vidhīyate**—occurs

O Arjuna! The unwise utter flowery speech, taking pleasure in the laudatory words of the Vedas, and say that there is nothing else but pleasures and enjoyments either here or in Heaven. They are full of desire, with heaven as their highest goal, leading to new births as the effect of their own Karma, and they engage themselves in a multiplicity of specific works for the purpose of acquiring enjoyments and prosperity. The mind of such men who are drawn away by attachment to pleasure and wealth, cannot be concentrated to remain fixed in the ecstasy of divine contemplation.

016. Chapter 2 Verses 45-47

VERSE 2.45

त्रैगुण्यविषया वेदा निस्त्रैगुण्यो भवार्जुन ।
निर्द्वन्द्वो नित्यसत्त्वस्थो निर्योगक्षेम आत्मवान् ॥ 45 ॥

*trai-guṇya-viṣhayā vedā nistrai-guṇyo bhavārjuna
nirdvandvo nitya-sattva-stho niryoga-kṣhema ātmavān*

trai-guṇya—of the three modes of material nature; **viṣhayāḥ**—subject matter; **vedāḥ**—Vedic scriptures; **nistrai-guṇyaḥ**—above the three modes of material nature, transcendental; **bhava**—be; **arjuna**—Arjun; **nirdvandvaḥ**—free from dualities; **nitya-sattva-sthaḥ**—eternally fixed in truth; **niryoga-kṣhemaḥ**—unconcerned about gain and preservation; **ātma-vān**—situated in the self

The first part of the Vedas (Karma Kanda) deal with material things pertaining to the three Gunas. One should transcend the three Gunas, become free from the operation of the pairs of opposites, take refuge in the pure sattvic state, and firmly establish himself in Atma.

VERSE 2.46

यावानर्थ उदपाने सर्वतः सम्प्लुतोदके ।
तावान्सर्वेषु वेदेषु ब्राह्मणस्य विजानतः ॥ 46 ॥

*yāvān artha udapāne sarvataḥ samplutodake
tāvānsarveṣhu vedeṣhu brāhmaṇasya vijānataḥ*

yāvān—whatever; **arthaḥ**—purpose; **uda-pāne**—a well of water; **sarvataḥ**—in all respects; **sampluta-udake**—by a large lake; **tāvān**—that many; **sarveṣhu**—in all; **vedeṣhu**—Vedas; **brāhmaṇasya**—one who realises the Absolute Truth; **vijānataḥ**—who is in complete knowledge

To an enlightened person who has known the Self, all the Vedas are of as much use as is a reservoir of water in a place where there is a flood.

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇy-evādhikāras te mā phaleṣhu kadāchana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo 'stvakarmaṇi

karmaṇi—in prescribed duties; **eva**—only; **adhikāraḥ**—right; **te**—your; **mā**—not; **phaleṣhu**—in the fruits; **kadāchana**—at any time; **mā**—never; **karma-phala**—results of the activities; **hetuḥ**—cause; **bhūḥ**—be; **mā**—not; **te**—your; **saṅgaḥ**—attachment; **astu**—must be; **akarmaṇi**—in inaction

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.

017. Chapter 2 Verses 47

VERSE 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇy-evādhikāras te mā phaleṣhu kadāchana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo 'stvakarmaṇi

karmaṇi—in prescribed duties; **eva**—only; **adhikāraḥ**—right; **te**—your; **mā**—not; **phaleṣhu**—in the fruits; **kadāchana**—at any time; **mā**—never; **karma-phala**—results of the activities; **hetuḥ**—cause; **bhūḥ**—be; **mā**—not; **te**—your; **saṅgaḥ**—attachment; **astu**—must be; **akarmaṇi**—in inaction

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.

018. Chapter 2 Verses 48-51

VERSE 2.48

योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय ।
सिद्धयसिद्धयोः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥ 48 ॥

yoga-sthaḥ kuru karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā dhanañjaya
siddhy-asiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā samatvaṁ yoga uchyate

yoga-sthaḥ—being steadfast in yog; **kuru**—perform; **karmāṇi**—duties; **saṅgaṁ**—attachment; **tyaktvā**—having abandoned; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun; **siddhi-asiddhyoḥ**—in success and failure; **samaḥ**—equipoised; **bhūtvā**—becoming; **samatvam**—equanimity; **yogaḥ**—Yog; **uchyate**—is called

O Arjuna! Steadfast in Yoga, giving up all attachment, unmindful of success or failure, do your work. Such equanimity of mind is called Yoga.

VERSE 2.49

दूरेण ह्यवरं कर्म बुद्धियोगाद्धनञ्जय ।
बुद्धौ शरणमन्विच्छ कृपणाः फलहेतवः ॥ 49 ॥

dūreṇa hy-avarāṁ karma buddhi-yogād dhanañjaya
buddhau śharaṇam anvichchha kṛpaṇāḥ phala-hetavaḥ

dūreṇa—(dis)crad from far away; **hi**—certainly; **avarām**—inferior; **karma**—reward-seeking actions; **buddhi-yogāt**—with the intellect established in Divine knowledge; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun; **buddhau**—divine knowledge and insight; **śharaṇam**—refuge; **anvichchha**—seek; **kṛpaṇāḥ**—miserly; **phala-hetavaḥ**—those seeking fruits of their work

O Arjuna! Work with attachment is far inferior to nishkama karma. Therefore seek refuge in desireless action with equanimity of mind. Those who work for fruits and rewards are wrecked.

बुद्धियुक्तो जहातीह उभे सुकृतदुष्कृते ।
तस्माद्योगाय युज्यस्व योगः कर्मसु कौशलम् ॥ 50 ॥

buddhi-yukto jahātiha ubhe sukrīta-duṣhkṛite
tasmād yogāya yujyasva yogaḥ karmasu kauśhalam

buddhi-yuktaḥ—endowed with wisdom; **jahāti**—get rid of; **iha**—in this life; **ubhe**—both; **sukrīta-duṣhkṛite**—good and bad deeds; **tasmāt**—therefore; **yogāya**—for Yog; **yujyasva**—strive for; **yogaḥ**—yog is; **karmasu kauśhalam**—the art of working skillfully

The man of equanimity born of wisdom releases himself both from good and bad even in this life. Therefore strive for nishkama karma with an equal mind. Yoga is skill in action.

कर्मजं बुद्धियुक्ता हि फलं त्यक्त्वा मनीषिणः ।
जन्मबन्धविनिर्मुक्ताः पदं गच्छन्त्यनामयम् ॥ 51 ॥

karma-jam buddhi-yuktā hi phalaṁ tyaktvā manīṣiṇaḥ
janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ padam gachchhanty-anāmayam

karma-jam—born of fruitive actions; **buddhi-yuktāḥ**—endowed with equanimity of intellect; **hi**—as; **phalam**—fruits; **tyaktvā**—abandoning; **manīṣiṇaḥ**—the wise; **janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ**—freedom from the bondage of life and death; **padam**—state; **gachchhanti**—attain; **anāmayam**—devoid of sufferings

Wise men endowed with equanimity, having abandoned the fruits of action, go to the abode beyond all sorrow and evil.

019. Chapter 2 Verses 52-54

VERSE 2.52

यदा ते मोहकलिलं बुद्धिर्व्यतितरिष्यति ।
तदा गन्तासि निर्वेदं श्रोतव्यस्य श्रुतस्य च ॥ 52 ॥

*yadā te moha-kalilam buddhir vyatitariṣhyati
tadā gantāsi nirvedam śrotavyasya śrutasya cha*

yadā—when; te—your; moha—delusion; kalilam—quagmire; buddhiḥ—intellect; vyatitariṣhyati—crosses; tadā—then; gantāsi—you shall acquire; nirvedam—indifferent; śrotavyasya—to what is yet to be heard; śrutasya—to what has been heard; cha—and

When your mind has crossed the mire of delusion, you will achieve indifference regarding things already heard and things yet to be heard.

VERSE 2.53

श्रुतिविप्रतिपन्ना ते यदा स्थास्यति निश्चला ।
समाधावचला बुद्धिस्तदा योगमवाप्स्यसि ॥ 53 ॥

*śruti-vipratipannā te yadā sthāsyati niśchalā
samādhāv-achalā buddhis tadā yogam avāpsyasi*

śruti-vipratipannā—not allured by the fruitive sections of the Vedas; te—your; yadā—when; sthāsyati—remains; niśchalā—steadfast; samādhau—in divine consciousness; achalā—steadfast; buddhiḥ—intellect; tadā—at that time; yogam—Yog; avāpsyasi—you will attain

When your intellect which is perplexed by hearing the various sastras becomes steady and immovable in ecstatic concentration, then you shall attain union with the Supreme Being.

अर्जुन उवाच ।
स्थितप्रज्ञस्य का भाषा समाधिस्थस्य केशव ।
स्थितधीः किं प्रभाषेत किमासीत ब्रजेत किम् ॥ 54 ॥

arjuna uvācha

sthita-prajñasya kā bhāṣhā samādhī-sthasya keśhava

sthita-dhīḥ kiṁ prabhāṣheta kim āsīta vrajeta kim

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **sthita-prajñasya**—one with steady intellect; **kā**—what; **bhāṣhā**—talk; **samādhī-sthasya**—situated in divine consciousness; **keśhava**—Shree Krishna, killer of the Keshi Demon; **sthita-dhīḥ**—enlightened person; **kim**—what; **prabhāṣheta**—talks; **kim**—how; **āsīta**—sits; **vrajeta**—walks; **kim**—how

Arjuna said: O Krishna! What are the characteristics of a man of steady wisdom? How does the man merged in the super-conscious state, sit and move?

020. Chapter 2 Verses 55-56

VERSE 2.55

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
प्रजहाति यदा कामान्सर्वान्पार्थ मनोगतान् ।
आत्मन्येवात्मना तुष्टः स्थितप्रज्ञस्तदोच्यते ॥ 55 ॥

śhrī bhagavān uvācha

prajahāti yadā kāmān sarvān pārtha mano-gatān

ātmany-evātmanā tuṣṭaḥ sthita-prajñas tadochyate

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—The Supreme Lord said; **prajahāti**—discards; **yadā**—when; **kāmān**—selfish desires; **sarvān**—all; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **manaḥ-gatān**—of the mind; **ātmani**—of the self; **eva**—only; **ātmanā**—by the purified mind; **tuṣṭaḥ**—satisfied; **sthita-prajñāḥ**—one with steady intellect; **tadā**—at that time; **uchyate**—is said

The Blessed Lord said: When a man renounces completely all the desires of the mind, and when he is fully satisfied with his mind fixed in Atma, then he is declared to be a man of steady wisdom.

VERSE 2.56

दुःखेष्वनुद्विग्नमनाः सुखेषु विगतस्पृहः ।
वीतरागभयक्रोधः स्थितधीर्मुनिरुच्यते ॥ 56 ॥

duḥkheṣhv-anudvigna-manāḥ sukheṣhu vigata-sprīhaḥ

vīta-rāga-bhaya-krodhaḥ sthita-dhīr munir uchyate

duḥkheṣhu—amidst miseries; **anudvigna-manāḥ**—one whose mind is undisturbed; **sukheṣhu**—in pleasure; **vigata-sprīhaḥ**—without craving; **vīta**—free from; **rāga**—attachment; **bhaya**—fear; **krodhaḥ**—anger; **sthita-dhīḥ**—enlightened person; **munīḥ**—a sage; **uchyate**—is called

He whose mind is not troubled in sorrow, who does not hanker after pleasures and is free from attachment fear and hatred, is called the sage of steady wisdom.

021. Chapter 2 Verses 56-57

VERSE 2.56

दुःखेष्वनुद्विग्नमनाः सुखेषु विगतस्पृहः ।
वीतरागभयक्रोधः स्थितधीर्मुनिरुच्यते ॥ 56 ॥

*duḥkheṣhv-anudvigna-manāḥ sukheṣhu vigata-sprīhaḥ
vīta-rāga-bhaya-krodhaḥ sthita-dhīr munir uchyate*

duḥkheṣhu—amidst miseries; **anudvigna-manāḥ**—one whose mind is undisturbed; **sukheṣhu**—in pleasure; **vigata-sprīhaḥ**—without craving; **vīta**—free from; **rāga**—attachment; **bhaya**—fear; **krodhaḥ**—anger; **sthita-dhīr**—enlightened person; **munīḥ**—a sage; **uchyate**—is called

He whose mind is not troubled in sorrow, who does not hanker after pleasures and is free from attachment fear and hatred, is called the sage of steady wisdom.

VERSE 2.57

यः सर्वत्रानभिस्नेहस्तत्तत्प्राप्य शुभाशुभम् ।
नाभिनन्दति न द्वेष्टि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 57 ॥

*yaḥ sarvatrānabhisnehas tat tat prāpya śhubhāśhubham
nābhinandati na dveṣṭi tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā*

yaḥ—who; **sarvatra**—in all conditions; **anabhisnehaḥ**—unattached; **tat**—that; **tat**—that; **prāpya**—attaining; **śhubha**—good; **āśhubham**—evil; **na**—neither; **abhinandati**—delight in; **na**—nor; **dveṣṭi**—dejected by; **tasya**—his; **prajñā**—knowledge; **pratiṣṭhitā**—is fixed

He who has no attachment to anything anywhere, who does not rejoice and hate when good and bad things happen, his wisdom is fixed and steady.

022. Chapter 2 Verses 58

VERSE 2.58

यदा संहरते चायं कूर्मोऽङ्गानीव सर्वशः ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेभ्यस्तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 58 ॥

yadā sanharate chāyaṁ kūrmo 'ṅgānīva sarvaśhaḥ
indriyāṇīndriyārthebhyas tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā

yadā—when; **sanharate**—withdraw; **cha**—and; **ayam**—this; **kūrmaḥ**—tortoise; **aṅgāni**—limbs; **iva**—as; **sarvaśhaḥ**—fully; **indriyāṇi**—senses; **indriya-arthebhyah**—from the sense objects; **tasya**—his; **prajñā**—divine wisdom; **pratiṣṭhitā**—fixed in

When the yogi, like the tortoise drawing back its limbs into its own shell, withdraws all the senses from the sense objects, his wisdom is firmly fixed.

023. Chapter 2 Verses 59-63

VERSE 2.59

विषया विनिवर्तन्ते निराहारस्य देहिनः ।
रसवर्जं रसोऽप्यस्य परं दृष्ट्वा निवर्तते ॥ 59 ॥

*viṣhayā vinivartante nirāhārasya dehinaḥ
rasa-varjaṁ raso 'pyasya param dṛiṣṭvā nivartate*

viṣhayāḥ—objects for senses; **vinivartante**—restrain; **nirāhārasya**—practicing self restraint; **dehinaḥ**—for the embodied; **rasa-varjaṁ**—cessation of taste; **rasaḥ**—taste; **api**—however; **asya**—person's; **param**—the Supreme; **dṛiṣṭvā**—on realisation; **nivartate**—ceases to be

When a man rejects the sense objects by withdrawing the senses, he becomes free from the sense world only. The longing or taste for them still remains in the mind. Even this longing is removed when the self is perceived.

VERSE 2.60

यततो ह्यपि कौन्तेय पुरुषस्य विपश्चितः ।
इन्द्रियाणि प्रमाथीनि हरन्ति प्रसभं मनः ॥ 60 ॥

*yatato hyapi kaunteya puruṣhasya vipaśhchitaḥ
indriyāṇi pramāthīni haranti prasabhaṁ manaḥ*

yatataḥ—while practicing self-control; **hi**—for; **api**—even; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **puruṣhasya**—of a person; **vipaśhchitaḥ**—one endowed with discrimination; **indriyāṇi**—the senses; **pramāthīni**—turbulent; **haranti**—carry away; **prasabham**—forcibly; **manaḥ**—the mind

O Arjuna! The turbulent senses carry away the mind even of the learned man though he is striving to control them.

तानि सर्वाणि संयम्य युक्त आसीत मत्परः ।
वशे हि यस्येन्द्रियाणि तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 61 ॥

*tāni sarvāṇi sanyamya yukta āsīta mat-parah
vaśhe hi yasyendriyāṇi tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā*

tāni—them; **sarvāṇi**—all; **sanyamya**—subduing; **yuktaḥ**—united; **āsīta**—seated; **mat-parah**—toward me (Shree Krishna); **vaśhe**—control; **hi**—certainly; **yasya**—whose; **indriyāṇi**—senses; **tasya**—their; **prajñā**—perfect knowledge; **pratiṣṭhitā**—is fixed;

Having restrained all the senses the harmonized should sit intent on me. His wisdom is steady whose senses are under control.

ध्यायतो विषयान्पुंसः सङ्गस्तेषूपजायते ।
सङ्गात्सञ्जायते कामः कामात्क्रोधोऽभिजायते ॥ 62 ॥
क्रोधाद्भवति सम्मोहः सम्मोहात्स्मृतिविभ्रमः ।
स्मृतिभ्रंशाद् बुद्धिनाशो बुद्धिनाशात्प्रणश्यति ॥ 63 ॥

*dhyāyato viṣhayān puṁsaḥ saṅgas teṣhūpajāyate
saṅgāt sañjāyate kāmah kāmāt krodho 'bhijāyate
krodhād bhavati sammohah sammohāt smṛiti-vibhramah
smṛiti-bhranśhād buddhi-nāsho buddhi-nāśhāt praṇaśhyati*

dhyāyataḥ—contemplating; **viṣhayān**—sense objects; **puṁsaḥ**—of a person; **saṅgaḥ**—attachment; **teṣhu**—to them (sense objects); **upajāyate**—arises; **saṅgāt**—from attachment; **sañjāyate**—develops; **kāmah**—desire; **kāmāt**—from desire; **krodhaḥ**—anger; **abhijāyate**—arises krodhāt—from anger; **bhavati**—comes; **sammohah**—clouding of judgement; **sammohāt**—from clouding of judgement; **smṛiti**—memory; **vibhramah**—bewilderment; **smṛiti-bhranśhāt**—from bewilderment of memory; **buddhi-nāśhah**—destruction of intellect; **buddhi-nāśhāt**—from destruction of intellect; **praṇaśhyati**—one is ruined

As a man contemplates sense-objects, attachment for them arises, from attachment, desire for them will be born, from desire arises anger, from anger comes delusion, from delusion, comes loss of memory, from loss of memory, comes destruction of discrimination, and from destruction of discrimination he perishes.

024. Chapter 2 Verses 64-66

VERSE 2.64

रागद्वेषवियुक्तैस्तु विषयानिन्द्रियैश्चरन् ।
आत्मवश्यैर्विधेयात्मा प्रसादमधिगच्छति ॥ 64 ॥

*rāga-dveṣha-viyuktais tu viṣhayān indriyaiś charan
ātma-vaśhyair-vidheyātmā prasādam adhigachchhati*

rāga—attachment; **dveṣha**—aversion; **viyuktaiḥ**—free; **tu**—but; **viṣhayān**—objects of the senses; **indriyaiḥ**—by the senses; **charan**—while using; **ātma-vaśhyaiḥ**—controlling one's mind; **vidheya-ātmā**—one who controls the mind; **prasādam**—the Grace of God; **adhigachchhati**—attains

But the self-controlled man free from attraction and repulsion, with his senses under restraint though moving among objects, attains peace.

VERSE 2.65

प्रसादे सर्वदुःखानां हानिरस्योपजायते ।
प्रसन्नचेतसो ह्याशु बुद्धिः पर्यवतिष्ठते ॥ 65 ॥

*prasāde sarva-duḥkhānām hānir asyopajāyate
prasanna-chetaso hyāśhu buddhiḥ paryavatiṣṭhate*

prasāde—by divine grace; **sarva**—all; **duḥkhānām**—of sorrows; **hāniḥ**—destruction; **asya**—his; **upajāyate**—comes; **prasanna-chetasah**—with a tranquil mind; **hi**—indeed; **āśhu**—soon; **buddhiḥ**—intellect; **paryavatiṣṭhate**—becomes firmly established

When a man attains peace, all sorrow and suffering caused by the unbalanced mind and rebellious senses come to an end. By peace and purity, the mind is soon fixed in the Self.

नास्ति बुद्धिरयुक्तस्य न चायुक्तस्य भावना ।
न चाभावयतः शान्तिरशान्तस्य कुतः सुखम् ॥ 66 ॥

*nāsti buddhir-ayuktasya na chāyuktasya bhāvanā
na chābhāvayataḥ śhāntir aśhāntasya kutaḥ sukham*

na—not; asti—is; buddhiḥ—intellect; ayuktasya—not united; na—not; cha—and; ayuktasya—not united; bhāvanā—contemplation; na—nor; cha—and; abhāvayataḥ—for those not united; śhāntiḥ—peace; aśhāntasya—of the unpeaceful; kutaḥ—where; sukham—happiness

The man whose mind is not under his control has no Self-knowledge and no contemplation either. Without contemplation he can have no peace; and without peace, how can he have happiness?

025. Chapter 2 Verses 67-69

VERSE 2.67

इन्द्रियाणां हि चरतां यन्मनोऽनुविधीयते ।
तदस्य हरति प्रज्ञां वायुर्नावमिवाम्भसि ॥ 67 ॥

indriyāṇāṃ hi charatām yan mano 'nuvidhīyate
tadasya harati prajñām vāyur nāvam ivāmbhasi

indriyāṇām—of the senses; hi—indeed; charatām—roaming; yat—which; manah—the mind; anuvidhīyate—becomes constantly engaged; tat—that; asya—of that; harati—carries away; prajñām—intellect; vāyuh—wind; nāvam—boat; iva—as; ambhasi—on the water

As a strong wind sweeps away a boat on the water, even one of the senses on which the mind focuses can carry away the discrimination.

VERSE 2.68

तस्माद्यस्य महाबाहो निगृहीतानि सर्वशः ।
इन्द्रियाणीन्द्रियार्थेभ्यस्तस्य प्रज्ञा प्रतिष्ठिता ॥ 68 ॥

tasmād yasya mahā-bāho nigrihitāni sarvaśhaḥ
indriyāṇindriyārthebhyas tasya prajñā pratiṣṭhitā

tasmāt—therefore; yasya—whose; mahā-bāho—mighty-armed one; nigrihitāni—restrained; sarvaśhaḥ—completely; indriyāṇi—senses; indriya-arthebhyah—from sense objects; tasya—of that person; prajñā—transcendental knowledge; pratiṣṭhitā—remains fixed

Therefore, O Arjuna! his knowledge is steady whose senses are completely restrained from all sense objects.

या निशा सर्वभूतानां तस्यां जागर्ति संयमी ।
यस्यां जाग्रति भूतानि सा निशा पश्यतो मुनेः ॥ 69 ॥

*yā niśhā sarva-bhūtānām tasyām jāgarti sanyamī
yasyām jāgrati bhūtāni sā niśhā paśhyato muneḥ*

yā—which; niśhā—night; sarva-bhūtānām—of all living beings; tasyām—in that; jāgarti—is awake; sanyamī—self-controlled; yasyām—in which; jāgrati—are awake; bhūtāni—creatures; sā—that; niśhā—night; paśhyataḥ—see; muneḥ—sage

That which is, night to all beings, in it the sage is awake; where all beings are awake, that is the night for the sage who sees (the Self).

026. Chapter 2 Verses 70-72

VERSE 2.70

आपूर्यमाणमचलप्रतिष्ठं
समुद्रमापः प्रविशन्ति यद्वत् ।
तद्वत्कामा यं प्रविशन्ति सर्वे
स शान्तिमाप्नोति न कामकामी ॥ 70 ॥

*āpūryamāṇam achala-pratiṣṭham
samudram āpaḥ praviśhanti yadvat
tadvat kāmā yaṁ praviśhanti sarve
sa śhāntim āpnoti na kāma-kāmī*

āpūryamāṇam—filled from all sides; achala-pratiṣṭham—undisturbed; samudram—ocean; āpaḥ—waters; praviśhanti—enter; yadvat—as; tadvat—likewise; kāmāḥ—desires; yaṁ—whom; praviśhanti—enter; sarve—all; saḥ—that person; śhāntim—peace; āpnoti—attains; na—not; kāma-kāmī—one who strives to satisfy desires

As the ocean is filled with water flowing into it from all sides and remains immovable, so the man into whom all desires flow, but is not a bit affected attains peace and not the man who craves the desires.

VERSE 2.71

विहाय कामान्यः सर्वान्पुमांश्चरति निःस्पृहः ।
निर्ममो निरहङ्कारः स शान्तिमधिगच्छति ॥ 71 ॥

*vihāya kāmān yaḥ sarvān pumānśh charati niḥsprihaḥ
nirmamo nirahankāraḥ sa śhāntim adhigachchhati*

vihāya—giving up; kāmān—material desires; yaḥ—who; sarvān—all; pumān—a person; charati—lives; niḥsprihaḥ—free from hankering; nirmamaḥ—without a sense of proprietorship; nirahankāraḥ—without egoism; saḥ—that person; śhāntim—perfect peace; adhigachchhati—attains

That man who lives completely free from desires, without longing, devoid of the sense of “I” and “mine,” attains peace.

एषा ब्राह्मी स्थितिः पार्थ नैनं प्राप्य विमुह्यति ।
स्थित्वास्यामन्तकालेऽपि ब्रह्मनिर्वाणमृच्छति ॥ 72 ॥

eṣhā brāhmī sthitiḥ pārtha naināṁ prāpya vimuhyati
sthitvāsyām anta-kāle 'pi brahma-nirvāṇam ṛichchhati

eṣhā—such; **brāhmī sthitiḥ**—state of God-realisation; **pārtha**—Arjun, the son of Pritha; **na**—never; **enām**—this; **prāpya**—having attained; **vimuhyati**—is deluded; **sthitvā**—being established; **asyām**—in this; **anta-kāle**—at the hour of death; **api**—even; **brahma-nirvāṇam**—liberation from Maya; **ṛichchhati**—attains

Having obtained this Brahmi state man is not deluded. Being established in this even at the end of life man attains oneness with Brahman (Moksha).